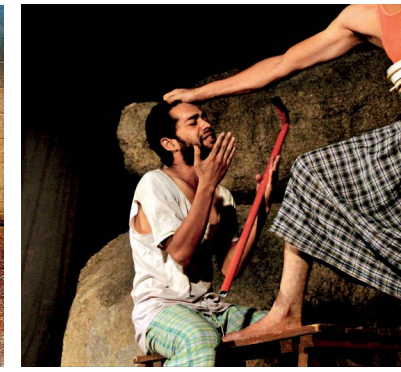


PIERO CEFALONI







A STAGE FOR ALL (clockwise from left) scenes from Adishakti's *Bali* and *Bhoomi*; Sutradhar's *Biryani and Haleem*; Dur Se Brothers' *The Far Post*

THEATRE

CELEBRATING COMMUNITY

The inaugural edition of the month-long ***Manam Theatre Festival*** *in Hyderabad promises a window into a diversity of performing arts*

While the art and culture scene in Hyderabad may be much talked about, a certain level of stagnancy seems to have crept in post-pandemic. The inaugural edition of the Manam Theatre Festival, presented by The WE_US Collective (the social and cultural programme of the Almond House Foundation initiative) promises to shake things up with its impressive line-up of performing acts by artists across geographies.

Spanning four weekends from November 24–December 17, the festival will showcase performances by four visiting and four Hyderabad-based troupes across four venues in the city. From puppetry to live music, dancing to masking, and more, the event is all about diversity in theatre. Alongside, a series of fringe events like mini talks, meet and greets, workshops and demonstrations have also been planned to offer visitors a chance to dive deep into the nuances of theatre.

"Live performances took a hit during the pandemic, inherently because they require a crowd. Having been associated with theatre for over a decade now, I believe there's so much that's yet to be explored. Our thought behind this festival is to bring the community together and to have a ball," says Harika Vedula, founder of The WE_US Collective and curator and organiser of the Manam Theatre Festival.

The Manam Theatre Festival will showcase performances by four visiting and four Hyderabad-based troupes across four venues in the city

The festival is set to make a strong statement on inclusivity, with both established and emerging theatre performers having a stage to showcase their art. While each of the 18 shows on offer has been thoughtfully curated,